COMPLAINTS AND GRIEVANCES POLICY

ISSUED 23/10/2025

PURPOSE: The Club is committed to providing a safe, respectful, and supportive environment for all volunteers, members, families and anyone involved with the Club. This policy provides a clear process for raising, managing, and resolving complaints or grievances fairly, promptly, and confidentially

REVISION: All Club policies, procedures guides and checklists are reviewed every January following the appointment of the new committee in November of each year. They may also be reviewed before each season or too meet compliance requirements.

PROCEDURE:

1. **Raising a Complaint**
   - Complaints should ideally be raised **as soon as possible** with the person directly involved, if safe and appropriate.
   - If direct resolution is not possible, complaints should be submitted in writing to the **Committee** via hello@bendigophoenix.org.au.
2. **Acknowledgement**
   - Complaints will be acknowledged **within 5 business days**.
   - The complainant will be informed of the expected timeline for resolution.
3. **Investigation**
   - The committee will **investigate complaints fairly**, gathering relevant information from all parties involved.
   - The investigation may involve interviews, document review, and other relevant inquiries.
4. **Resolution**
   - Outcomes may include:

SCOPE: This policy applies to all volunteers, members, families and anyone involved with the Club. It covers complaints regarding behaviour, decisions, breaches of policies, or other concerns related to the organisation.

PRINCIPLES:

- **Accessibility:** Everyone can raise a complaint without fear of disadvantage.
- **Fairness:** Complaints will be handled objectively and impartially.
- **Confidentiality:** Complaints are treated with discretion and information is shared only on a need-to-know basis.
- **Timeliness:** Complaints will be addressed promptly.
- **Resolution-focused:** The goal is to resolve matters constructively and maintain positive relationships.

PHOENIX UNITED BASKETBALL DEVELOPMENT CLUB INC
HELLO@BENDIGOPHOENIX.ORG.AU WWW.BENDIGOPHOENIX.ORG.AU

COMPLAINTS AND GRIEVANCES POLICY

ISSUED 23/10/2025

- Mediation or facilitated discussion
- Formal warning or disciplinary action
- Changes to policies, procedures, or practices
- No further action, if complaint is unfounded

- The complainant will be informed of the outcome in writing.

5. **Appeals**

- If a complainant is dissatisfied with the outcome, they may request an appeal to the **Committee**.
- Appeals must be submitted in writing within **10 business days** of the original outcome.

DEFINITIONS:

- **Complaint:** An expression of dissatisfaction about behaviour, actions, or decisions.
- **Grievance:** A more formal dispute or concern regarding policies, procedures, or treatment within the organisation.

CONFIDENTIALITY:

- All complaints will be treated confidentially.
- Records will be securely stored, in line with privacy obligations.
- Only people directly involved in handling the complaint will have access to details.

PROTECTION FROM REPRISAL:
Retaliation or victimisation against anyone raising a complaint in good faith will not be tolerated.

RELATED POLICIES

- Child Safety Policy
- All Code of Conduct Policies
- Privacy Policy
- Volunteer Policy

PHOENIX UNITED BASKETBALL DEVELOPMENT CLUB INC
HELLO@BENDIGOPHOENIX.ORG.AU WWW.BENDIGOPHOENIX.ORG.AU